

Sir Isaac Newton

--Nathaniel Hawthorne

About the Author

Nathaniel Hawthorne (July 4, 1804 – May 19, 1864) was an American novelist, dark romantic, and short story writer. His works often focus on history, morality, and religion. He was born in 1804 in Salem, Massachusetts, to Nathaniel Hawthorne and the former Elizabeth Clarke Manning. The biography of Sir Isaac Newton was published in Nathaniel Hawthorne's, True Stories from History and Biography (1851).

Summary:

Section - I

Isaac Newton was born in 1642 in a village in England. He was brought up by his kind grandmother. During his school days, he was remarkable for his ingenuity. He invented curious articles with his tools. His neighbours and grandmother admired his inventions and believed he would be a capital workman in future.

His friends wanted him to be an apprentice for a clockmaker. Newton was good in mechanical and maths skills. He made curious clocks like the dancing figures, the sailing ship as the pendulum vibrates and the clock that worked by the dropping of water. Newton also made a sun-dial which is still in his house at Woolsthorpe. He could acquire knowledge in simple ways. Like, to find the strength of the wind, he jumped against the wind and by the length of his jump, he calculated the force of the wind.

Newton frequently went to the new windmill near his house and examined its parts and internal machines for many hours. When the windmill was working, he watched the process by which the mill-stones revolved and crushed the grains. Thus he learnt about the construction of the windmill and he made his own small windmill with available materials like box-traps, linen for sails. When this windmill was placed in the air, even a puff of wind from Newton's mouth

made the windmill work and the handful of rains put into it turned to snow-white flour.

Section - II

Isaac Newton's playmates always admired his toys, particularly the windmills. But one of his friends said that he had forgotten something in the making of the windmill, when Isaac was sure that it lacked nothing. It lacked a miller. As Isaac grew older, he started thinking beyond making toys. He isolated himself, thought deeply, read some book of mathematics or philosophy and at nights he observed the stars. He asked himself many curious questions about the world of stars, their distance from earth, their orbits, hold force and so on.

After fourteen years he helped his widow mother, but his mind was bent to become a scholar. So his mother sent him to the University of Cambridge. Isaac was the first to find the nature of Light. When an apple fell on his head, he discovered the force of gravitation. He tracked the orbits of the planets and stars on the sky. When he was doing his researches, he spent all nights on a tower, gazing the heavenly bodies through a telescope. His mind was above this world.

He spent most of his life in the world that lie millions of miles away. Sir Isaac Newton died in 1727 when he was 85 years old. He was a Member of Parliament and received the honour of knighthood from the king. But he was not proud of his earthly fame or knowledge. His name is written in letters of light, formed by the stars in mid sky. Mr. George and Mr. Temple remark that if Isaac had lived longer, he would have found all the other inventions of today too.

Glossary

ingenuity (n) – the ability to invent things / creativity

contrived (v) – created / invented

apprentice (v) – works for someone to learn skill

acquiring (v) – getting knowledge or skill

pried (v) investigated

hopper (n) – funnel shaped bins for feeding grains into mills

enchanted (v) – delighted

miniature (adj) – very small model

curiosity (n) – eagerness

accustomed (v) – something familiar with

gazing (v) – looking steadily and intently

ceased (v) – stopped

B. Answer the following questions in one or two

1. Who was taking care of Newton after his father's death?

Newton was left to the care of his good old grandmother.

2. What did Isaac manufacture at his young age?

Isaac manufactured a set of little tools and saws of various sizes.

3. How did the young boy find the strength of the wind?

Isaac manufactured a set of little tools and saws of various sizes.

4. Why were his friends attracted by the windmill?

His friends were attracted by the windmill because they thought that they had not seen anything so pretty and wonderful in the whole world.

5. How was Newton honoured by the king?

Newton received the honor of knighthood from the king and became Sir Issac Newton.

War

-Luigi Pirandello

War (Original title: *Quando si comprende*) is a short story by Italian playwright and dramatist Luigi Pirandello first published in the short story collection *Un Cavallo nella Luna* in 1918.^[1] The story follows a discussion between parents of soldiers in the First World War about how they deal with grief.^{[2][3]} The story covers topics of patriotism, grief, and the destructive nature of war.^{[4][5]} It is regarded by some as one of the greatest short stories of the Interwar period, along with Jean-Paul Sartre's The Wall.^[6] The English translation of the story has since become a frequently taught piece of literature in the United States, Canada, and Germany.^{[7][8]}

Summary

The plot of Luigi Pirandello's "War" occurs during World War I in Italy, a setting of tremendous political and social upheaval. Although Italy emerged on the "winning" side of the war, the victory came with significant personal costs; over 600,000 Italians, primarily young men, were dead by the war's conclusion.

This great personal sacrifice is the subject of "War," in this short story, the suffering of parents is depicted with agonizing insight. Mothers and fathers travel together aboard a train, and their feelings of loss weigh heavily on them. One mother boards the train in a state of visible mourning; she looks like a "shapeless bundle" as she is "hoisted" into the train, unable to bear the weight of the effort herself.

As the passengers settle in for their journey, the woman's husband, "in deep mourning," addresses the other five passengers by commenting on the "nasty world" they find themselves in. He explains that the war has taken their only son from them, an event they had not adequately braced themselves to endure. His departure seems shockingly "sudden," and he comments that his wife is to be "pitied" for enduring such a tragedy.

As her husband speaks, the woman begins "growling like a wild animal," convinced that their plight is no worse than any of the other parents' feelings of loss. Indeed, the husband's comments generate a debate among the passengers about whose suffering is hardest to endure.

One passenger suggests that his loss is harder; while the couple's son is only now being sent to fight, his son has been fighting since "the first day of the war." He has even been injured *twice* and sent back to the front lines each time after recovering.

Another passenger suggests his loss is more profound; he has two sons and three nephews on the front lines of the war. Now a bit embarrassed by his comments, the husband replies

that even if this man loses one son, he can be comforted by his one surviving son. This angers the other passenger, who explains that if a man has only one son who dies, he can end his own life. A man with a surviving son cannot escape his distress and must endure the grief of that loss with no hope of escaping it.

This conversation angers another passenger, "panting" with an "inner violence of an uncontrolled vitality." He questions whether parents have given life to their children "for [their] own benefit." The man whose son has been at the front since the beginning of the war replies that their children belong "to the Country."

The man calls this "bosh" and insists that when their children are born, they "take [their parents' lives] with them...but they never belong to [their parents]." He explains that young people are passionate about their country in the same way their parents once were; over time, the love of country is replaced by an even deeper love for one's children.

However, he insists that "somebody must go to defend" their country out of "necessity," it is better to allow their sons to do so without tears and sadness. He then shares that his son had sent him a message before dying, revealing that he was satisfied to end his life "in the best way he could have wished."

The mother who had just sent her only son to the war is "amazed" and "stunned" by this man's speech; this world where people "congratulate" a father who has just lost his son in a war feels "unknown." In a state of shock, she asks the man whether his son is "really dead."

This question creates a moment of deep introspection for the father. At this moment, the father begins to grasp the finality of his son's life; he is "gone forever—forever." As reality settles in, the father breaks into "harrowing, heart-rending, uncontrollable sobs."

War Themes

The main themes of *War* include the futility of war, the loss of innocence, and the hypocrisy of patriotism.

- **The futility of war:** The characters in the story are all too aware of the pointlessness of the war in which they are fighting. They are not motivated by any sense of duty or patriotism, but merely by a desire to survive.
- **The loss of innocence:** The war takes a heavy toll on the innocence of the characters. They are forced to confront the possible loss of their loved ones and compatriots.
- **The hypocrisy of patriotism:** The characters in the story are all too aware of the emptiness of patriotic rhetoric. They see through the lies that their government is telling them, and they know that their country's aims are not really worth fighting for.

- **Patriotism**

In the background of the parents' discussions of their losses exists a bond that unites them all: feelings of patriotism. While each parent faces different circumstances in sending a son to war, none of the parents suggests that war should be avoided altogether. One father even suggests that "any one of us...[would] gladly take his son's place at the front if he could." The other passengers silently nod their approval to this sentiment.

The love of Country, he argues, is felt most deeply among a nation's youth, who have not yet begun their own families and have not yet experienced a bond that is even deeper than that to one's country: the love a parent feels for his child. He insists that "Country" as an idea is a "natural necessity." Therefore, there must be people willing to defend that idea.

This father has already lost his son in the war and finds comfort in the fact that his son died "in the best way he could have wished." Boys willing to die for Country are described as "decent boys, of course," indicating that a lack of patriotism indicates poor character. Another father comments that their children "do not belong to us, they belong to the Country."

The grief these parents face rests on the altar of their feelings of patriotism, which is also the fuel for the war. Ultimately the story demonstrates that while patriotic sentiments may guide and even win wars, parents and families must bear the deep grief associated with such "victories."

- **War and Loss**

War is often romanticized in literature as feelings of nationalism are bolstered to exemplify the great political success which can be achieved through united wartime efforts. "War," however, deconstructs the "positive" outcomes of war through an examination of what is required to achieve those "successes."

Using the perspective of parents, this short story focuses on the sacrifice individual families must make during times of war. The woman who initially boards the train is "in deep mourning," not because her son is dead but because she understands the likely sacrifice she must make as the mother of a soldier. Thus far, she has not found it in her heart to "resign [herself], without crying, not only to the departure of [her son] but even to [his] death," as other parents have done.

Another father tries to convince others—and himself—that dying in war is noble and that perhaps it is even better to end one's life "young and happy, without having the ugly sides of life" which come with aging. Yet when pressed to consider the implications of sacrificing his son for such "noble" causes, words "fail" the father as he realizes "at last" what he has truly and forever lost.

Notably, every person on the train is too old to fight, which highlights that the true sacrifices of war rest on the shoulders of a nation's youth. Within victorious national outcomes exist profound personal losses, which particularly affect a nation's young people.

Style and Technique

"War" examines a much-avoided truth regarding the historical context of World War I, whose events inspired Luigi Pirandello to pen a story reflecting the realistic struggles of ordinary people impacted by the conflict. To sustain patriotism and remain loyal to wartime efforts, citizens often bury their feelings of loss, which is particularly difficult as parents grieve the loss of their children.

Intellectually, these parents understand that they must support the wartime cause. Doing so furthers the goals of their country as a whole and sustains them and their families; war is compared to bread, a simplistic source of life-giving energy. One father insists that "each of us must eat" this "bread" to "defend" their most foundational beliefs. These words are reminiscent of the words Christ used at the Last Supper, which highlights the incredible sacrifice which is inherent in "lay[ing] down one's life for one's friends" (John 15:13).

Despite their intellectual acceptance of what "must" be sacrificed to support their country, the grief of these parents robs them of the dreams they had for their sons. Interestingly, the *mother* on the train seems to understand the profound truth of war. As the men debate their degrees of suffering, she "pull[s] up her collar...to her eyes, so as to hide her face," unable to face their discussion on such intimate feelings of anguish. She is physically superior to her husband, who is described as "thin" and "tiny," and she makes no excuses for the state of "deep mourning" she experiences.

This mother is not easily swayed by intellectual discourse. As she listens, she is astounded that no one seems to "share her feelings" and that this sacrifice is too great. For months, she has been unable to adequately convey her feelings to her closest friends or even to her husband; she cannot reconcile how she is supposed to willingly send her only son to a war where he will likely die.

These feelings make the mother feel oddly disjointed from her world. As she listens to the father speak bravely of his own son's death, she seems to be awakened "from a dream" and asks him a simple question: "Is your son really dead?"

Previously stoic and confident, the father is pierced by the mother's direct question. Burying his son during wartime caused the father to bury his grief so that he could continue to cling to his feelings of patriotism. When he allows himself to step outside the perpetuated mantras of nationalism and sacrifice, "words [fail] him."

Staring into the face of this mother whose son now effectively replaces his son on the front lines, he becomes aware of the truth. The war has *forever* robbed him of the future he had

imagined with his son. The sacrifice isn't temporary and can never be abated. As he considers this, his face reflects the "horrible distort [ion]" of the values he has accepted. The collapse of this worldview leaves him physically depleted as he breaks into "harrowing, heart-rending, uncontrollable sobs."

3. WHY I WANT A WIFE- JUDDY BRADY

1. From whose point of view is the essay *I Want a Wife*?

The essay is written from the **point of view of a woman**, specifically Judy Brady, who adopts a sarcastic tone to highlight gender inequality.

2. Who is the narrator in the essay? When did the thought of having a wife occur to the narrator?

The **narrator is Judy Brady herself**. The thought of having a wife **occurred when she was talking with a male friend who had recently divorced and was looking for a new wife**.

3. Who inspired the narrator in the essay to think of having a wife?

The **narrator's recently divorced male friend** inspired her to think of how convenient it would be to have a wife.

4. Name any two household chores of a dutiful wife.

Two household chores mentioned are: **Cooking meals ,Taking care of the children**

5. Why does the narrator want to go back to school?

The narrator wants to **go back to school to continue her education**, but sarcastically implies that she would need a wife to take care of everything else while she studies.

6. What does the narrator mean by replacing the present wife with another one?

The narrator is criticizing how **men often discard their wives for newer, more convenient ones**. It's a sarcastic way of showing how society treats women as replaceable based on men's needs.

7. In one sentence, define what Brady means by 'wife'. Does this ideal wife actually exist? Explain. Ans-

According to Brady, wife means someone, not necessarily a woman, who fulfill five types of duties- babysitters' duty, cooking duty, cleaning duty, social duty and sexual duty without being paid. This kind of ideal wife do not exist in reality but they are forcefully made of exists by male dominated society.

8. Why do you want a wife?

I want a wife for emotional companionship, mutual support, and partnership in life. A wife brings balance, shared responsibilities, and a sense of family, contributing to a fulfilling and stable life.

II. Long answer

1. List some of the specific duties of the wife Brady describes. Into what five general categories does Brady arrange these duties?

Ans- Judy Brady in this essay says that she needs a wife. After that she tells us why she is in need of wife. She gives us very strong reason for the need of wife.

While giving us reason, she has given us the definition of a wife in great details. While giving definition of wife, she has listed all the duties of a wife in five general categories.

a) Babysitter's Duty- While doing babysitter's duty, a wife is expected to look after all the children at home. A wife must feed the children, wash their clothes and iron well, keep them clean, take to hospital if they are sick, take them to park and zoo for enjoyment, make sure that they have done all the homework. Along with doing all these duty a wife must also work outside to earn money as well.

b) Cooking Duty- She must cook good food as well and feed husband and his whole family and friends sometimes. She needs to take special care of her husband when she is sick. While the family is on vacation or tour, she must go along them with to care of everything. The wife will not only cook only one kind of food but prepare varieties of food for different guests and family members at home.

c) Cleaning Duty- In cleaning duty the wife must clean the whole house. After picking up children from the school, she needs to pick up her husband from work/office. A wife must wash all the clothes, iron them, keep them in right place. She must do the shopping of necessary grocery.

d) Social Duty- In social duty, a wife must satisfy the wishes of all the guests who visit our home. A wife must prepare tasty food for the guest. When we go out for invitation, the wife must look after the children. The wife must take children to the bed early when our guests arrive at home so that the children will not disturb the guests. The wife must fill the glasses of our guest with wine and coffee if our guests want.

e) Sexual Duty- A wife must satisfy her husband's sexual wish at any time when the husband is in the mood. The wife must play with husband in bed at night. The wife must be careful for birth control. The wife must be sexually faithful to husband. The wife should not ask for sex when the husband is not in the mood. The wife should not complain her husband when he changes or bring new wife. If needed the wife must quite her job to satisfy her husband's wishes and desire.

2.What complains does Brady apparently have about the life she actually leads? To what does she seems to attributes her problems?

Ans- At the very beginning of the essay, Brady says "I belong to that classification of people known as wives. I am a wife". As she is destined to be 'wife', she has lots of complains in her life. A wife is supposed to do babysitting duty, cleaning duty, cooking duty, social duty, and sexual duty free of cost. According to the writer the main reason of her problems is name tag 'wife'. When someone is 'wife' of somebody, the above mentioned duties are necessarily to be fulfilled without any

questions. Here, we should not be mistaken that 'wife' is necessarily a woman. The 'wife' may be a man too. The important question not man or woman, but it is who does the five categories of duty free of cost, for whole life without any complain.

3. Describe how the essay *I Want a Wife* satirizes the unequal treatment of women in society.

In the essay *I Want a Wife* by Judy Brady, the author uses satire to criticize and expose the unfair and unequal treatment of women in a patriarchal society. The narrator, a woman, pretends to take on the voice of a man who is listing all the reasons he would like to have a wife. Through exaggerated and ironic statements, Brady highlights the unrealistic and one-sided expectations placed on wives.

The essay points out that women are expected to handle all domestic responsibilities—such as cooking, cleaning, and taking care of the children—while also supporting their husbands emotionally and socially. The narrator sarcastically suggests that a wife must do everything for her husband's comfort and convenience, with no regard for her own desires or needs.

This satire is powerful because it shows how wives are often treated more like servants than equal partners. The narrator mocks how men feel entitled to replace their wives whenever they want, especially if they find someone "better." By exaggerating the demands placed on a wife, Brady forces the reader to reflect on how unfair and oppressive these expectations are. The essay is a strong critique of gender roles and aims to provoke thought and change in how society views women and marriage.

2. What are the works and responsibilities assigned to a wife in a patriarchal society?

In a **patriarchal society**, the roles and responsibilities of a wife are often based on traditional gender roles that expect women to be submissive, nurturing, and entirely devoted to their husbands and families. A wife is usually assigned the major share of domestic and caregiving duties, regardless of whether she also works outside the home.

Some of the main responsibilities assigned to a wife include:

- **Household chores** such as cooking, cleaning, washing clothes, and maintaining the home.

- **Caring for children**, including feeding them, helping with schoolwork, taking them to appointments, and ensuring their well-being.
- **Catering to the husband's needs**, including physical, emotional, and social support, and often putting his career and desires ahead of her own.
- **Being a caretaker** for sick or elderly family members, especially in extended families.
- **Managing the household budget** and sometimes working outside the home to contribute financially, while still being expected to manage everything at home.

Despite the hard work and sacrifices, wives in a patriarchal system often do not receive equal respect, appreciation, or decision-making power. They are expected to be selfless and obedient, and their identities are often reduced to just being someone's wife or mother, instead of being seen as individuals with their own goals and rights.

The Black Cat Summary

On the eve of his death, an unnamed narrator opens the story by proclaiming that he is sane, despite the wild narrative he is about to convey. This narrative begins years before, when the narrator's honorable character is well known and celebrated. He confesses a great love for cats and dogs, both of which, he says, respect the fidelity of friendship, unlike fellow men. The narrator marries at a young age and introduces his wife to the domestic joys of owning pets. Among birds, goldfish, a dog, rabbits, and a monkey, the narrator singles out a large and beautiful black cat, named Pluto, as his favorite.

Though he loves Pluto, the narrator begins to suffer from violent mood swings, predominantly due to the influence of alcohol. He takes to mistreating not only the other animals but also his wife. During this uncontrollable rage, he spares only Pluto. After returning home quite drunk one night, the narrator lashes out at Pluto. Believing the cat has avoided him, he vengefully grasps the cat, only to be bitten on the hand. In demonic retaliation, the narrator pulls a penknife from his pocket and cuts out one of the cat's eyes. Though the narrator wakes the next morning with a partial feeling of remorse, he is unable to reverse the newly ominous course of his black soul. Ignored for certain now by the wounded cat, the narrator soon seeks further retaliation. He is overwhelmed by a spirit of PERVERSENESS, and sets out to commit wrong for the sake of wrong. He hangs Pluto from the limb of a tree one morning.

On the night of Pluto's hanging, the narrator's family's house burns down, but he dismisses the possibility of a connection between the two events. The day after the fire, which destroys all the narrator's possessions, he witnesses a group of neighbors collected around a wall that remains standing. Investigating their shouts of amazement, the narrator discovers the impression of a gigantic cat—with a rope around its neck—on the surface of the wall. The narrator attempts to explain rationally the existence of the impression, but he finds himself haunted by this phantasm over the course of many months. One night, while out drunk, the narrator discovers a black object poised upon a large barrel of alcohol. A new black cat has appeared, resembling Pluto but with a splash of white on his fur.

As with Pluto, the narrator experiences a great fondness for the mysterious cat, which no one has seen before. The cat becomes part of the household, much adored by his wife as well. However, following the earlier pattern, the narrator soon cannot resist feelings of hatred for the cat. These murderous sentiments intensify when the narrator discovers that the cat's splash of white fur has mysteriously taken on the shape of the gallows, the structure on which a hanging takes place. The white fur reveals the mode of execution that claimed Pluto, and the narrator pledges revenge.

One day, descending into the cellar of the building with his wife, the narrator almost trips over the cat. Enraged, the narrator grabs an axe to attack the cat, but his wife defends the animal. Further angered by this interference, the narrator turns his rage at his wife and buries the axe in her head. Faced with the evidence of his crime, the narrator considers many options for the body's disposal, including dismemberment and burial. The narrator eventually decides to take advantage of the damp walls in the basement and entomb the body behind their plaster. Without any difficulty, the narrator creates a tomb in the plaster wall, thereby hiding the body and all traces of his murder. When he finally turns to the cat, it is missing, and he concludes that it has been frightened away by his anger.

On the fourth day after the murder, the police arrive unexpectedly at the narrator's apartment. Cool and collected, the narrator leads them through the premises, even into the basement. Though facing the scene of the crime, the police do not demonstrate any curiosity and prepare to leave the residence. The narrator, however, keeps trying to allay their suspicion. Commenting upon the solid craftsmanship of the house, he taps on the wall—behind which is his wife's body—with a cane. In response to the tapping, a long, loud cry emanates from behind the wall. The police storm the wall and dismantle it, discovering the hidden corpse. Upon its head sits the missing cat.

Analysis

Much like “The Tell-Tale Heart,” “The Black Cat” follows the narrator's descent into madness after he proclaims his sanity in the tale's opening paragraph. Even the narrator acknowledges the “wild” nature of the tale, attempting thereby to separate his mental condition from the events of the plot. The nature of the narrator's madness differs from that of the narrator of “The Tell-Tale Heart.” “The Black Cat” does not concern itself only with the self-contained nature of the narrator's mind. Rather, the narrator confesses an alcoholism that interferes with his grasp on reality and produces mood swings. Alcohol is, like the cat, an external agent that intrudes on the dynamics of the plot. The introduction of alcohol as a plot device is also significant because Edgar Allan Poe was a reputedly uncontrollable drunk throughout his lifetime. For many years, his biographers asserted that he died of alcohol poisoning in a gutter in Baltimore. More recent biographies insist that the exact cause of Poe's death cannot be determined. Regardless, it is certain that Poe suffered from the deleterious effects of alcohol consumption throughout his life.

The influential literary critic Tzvetan Todorov introduced a concept of the “fantastic” in the early 1970s to discuss literature of horror, and the idea can be applied usefully to “The Black Cat.” The fantastic, he asserts, explores the indefinite boundary between the real and the supernatural. The fantastic is a literary category that contains elements of both the rational and the irrational. One of the fantastic elements in “The Black Cat” is the existence

of the second cat—with the changing shape of its white fur and its appearance on the corpse behind the wall. These plot twists challenge reality, but they do not completely substitute a supernatural explanation for a logical one. It is possible that the plot twists derive only from the insanity of the narrator. As a result, the plot twists, like the fantastic, hover between the real and the supernatural. The resolution of the story is both rationally possible and tremendously unlikely; the cat could inhabit the basement walls, but it is difficult to believe that it would remain silently in the wall for a long time or go unnoticed by the overly meticulous narrator.

The Black Cat Summary

Edgar Allan Poe's short story "The Black Cat" uses an unreliable narrator to tell a story of unrelenting mental instability that ends with a killer's self-revelation of his deadly deed.

The narrator boasts of his well-known kindness and compassion towards animals, which was mirrored by his wife. His favorite pet of theirs was a large black cat named Pluto. As the years passed, the narrator became more besotted by drink and consumed by his own cruelty and perverseness. He abused his wife and the animals.

Pluto, who was his favorite, bore the brunt of his rage. One day, the narrator cut out one of the cat's eyes, and not long after that, he hanged the cat from the branch of his tree.

The night of the hanging, the narrator's house caught fire and everything was lost. One remaining plaster wall featured the indent of the body of a cat, which was attributed to a neighbor throwing the cat inside the window to warn the sleepers of fire. This image utterly horrified the narrator.

Over time, the narrator began to pine for the cat. To his great delight, he found a cat that looked very similar to Pluto at a dive bar, and he took it home with him. This cat was also missing an eye, but its fur had a white patch on it, unlike Pluto's solid black coloring.

The narrator began to despise this creature as well, and its excessive attention to him made him insensate with rage. One day, the narrator and his wife ventured into the cellar of the building where they now lived, and the cat raced past them down the stairs. The narrator swung an ax to try to kill it, but when his wife stopped him, he killed her instead. He decided to wall up her body in one of the cellar walls.

After completing his task, he felt pleased with his work and the fact that the black cat had seemingly vanished.

After four days, the police came to thoroughly investigate his place. He felt not a twinge of guilt, only confidence that his wife's body would never be found. He tapped gleefully on the cellar walls, boasting of their construction. However, at that tapping, a terrible wailing howl came from inside the wall. The police pulled it down and found the corpse, as well as the black cat inside, staring straight at the narrator with his one eye.

The Black Cat Character List

Unnamed Narrator

The narrator is another of Poe's unnamed and unreliable men driven to madness. All we really know about him—if his word can be trusted, that is—is that he has enjoyed a lifetime love of animals and that the animals have reciprocated this love. The narrator does make clear what it is about animals that inspires in him a higher level of love and respect: he particularly admires their loyalty and perception. In other words, if an animal remains loyal to you, you must be a good person—which should bring into question the character of any person whose pet begins to exhibit *disloyal* behavior.

The Narrator's Wife

Not much information is provided about the narrator's wife other than that she shares his love of animals. We do learn that she might be more superstitious than he is since she is fond of mentioning the belief that cats and witches are inextricably linked. Of course, this information arrives courtesy of a narrator that is not entirely trustworthy, and even he is careful to assert that just because she mentions this superstition, doesn't necessarily mean she believes it. Ultimately, it is the narrator that seems to possess a deeper belief in supernatural explanations. One thing is for certain: the wife is willing to intrude on behalf of animals when in danger, even if that danger is her husband.

Pluto

Pluto is the black cat that joins the goldfish, rabbit, dog, birds, and monkey in the menagerie of pets that the narrator and his wife invite into their home. The close bond between cat and owner (i.e. the narrator) even manages to initially shield the cat from the abusive effects of the owner—effects that were already affecting the man's relationship with his other pets and his wife. The passage of time and the rise of addiction tolerance eventually takes their toll, however, resulting in Pluto first losing an eye at the narrator's hand before losing his life at the end of a noose.

The Second Black Cat

Following rather quickly upon the death of Pluto and an unexplained fire that destroys the narrator's home, a second black cat enters the narrative. This cat remains nameless, like the narrator. It is almost identical to Pluto, right down to having only one eye, but it has one distinguishing difference: a patch of white fur covering almost its entire breast. The lack of an actual name indicates the emotionless connection between it and the narrator that claims to be such an animal lover: despite a seemingly strong desire by the cat for them to become best friends, the narrator is utterly repulsed by the cat, to the eventual point of attempted murder.

The Police

The police arrive to investigate the disappearance of the narrator's wife. They catalyze the mad narrator's hubris, which leads him to inadvertently give away the murder he has continued.

The Black Cat Themes

Man's descent into insanity

In "The Black Cat," the narrator was aware that his thoughts and actions were transforming into a downward spiral. He was aware of his increased irritability, his disregard of the feelings of others, and the unreasonable violent actions he carried out towards his wife. He was even aware that his favorite pet and playmate, Pluto, was falling victim to the ill-effects brought by alcoholism onto the narrator. However, for reasons that remain inscrutable to the reader, he continues his descent into moral degeneration. Is he affected with "perverseness"? Is it a result of the alcohol? Does he not know what he is doing?

The ill-effects of alcoholism

In this story, the narrator describes to the readers the effects of the "Fiend Intemperance." It was due to the increased intake of alcohol that the narrator experienced a radical alteration for the worse. He became more irritable, cared little for the feelings of others, and often used intemperate language with his wife—not to mention the violent acts he committed towards her. He abused the rabbits, the dogs, the monkey, and even his favorite pet, Pluto. We do not know why he was driven to drink, and being drunk did not explain all of his evil deeds—but alcohol certainly exacerbated his behavior and helped him stray further from a unified self.

Supernatural beliefs

The theme of supernatural elements pervades this story. The title itself suggests supernatural elements, for there are various superstitions regarding the bad luck that a black cat allegedly brings. In this story, the narrator kills his pet—Pluto, a black cat—by hanging him from a tree branch. After the murder of the black cat, bad luck followed the narrator. His house burned down, only one wall remained, and that wall had an impression of the black cat with a rope about the animal's neck. A few days later, another black cat appeared in front of the narrator. This cat looked exactly like Pluto except it had a patch of white fur at the bosom, which later represented the "gallows." The events that followed the hanging of Pluto can be attributed to supernatural explanations, for it is a common belief that a black cat brings bad luck.

Guilt

The narrator's guilt is what brought the black cat back to haunt him. The cat represents his guilt: as the narrator became more guilty, the cat became more realistic. For example, the only time the cat was heard was when the police were searching the narrator's house, at which point his guilt and fear finally pushed him into full madness. The narrative shows that guilt is a key factor in man's descent into madness—yet also a vital part of what keeps us human.

The Divided Self

The narrator experiences a fragmented, divided self. This is apparent not only in the dichotomy between the man telling the tale and the man committing the acts in the tale, but also in terms of nearly all of his actions once his "perverseness" set in. He vacillated

between sanity and insanity, between fear and horror of the cat and the impulse to act. He had nightmares, drunken stupors, and paroxysms of rage and despair. He killed his cat and then desired another one; he felt poorly for his long-suffering wife but murdered her without a thought. The only bliss and peace he had were when he completely lost himself after killing his wife and walling up the cat in the tomb.

About the author:

The Black Cat, short story by Edgar Allan Poe, first published in *The Saturday Evening Post* in August 1843 and included in Poe's 1845 collection *Tales*.

Edgar Allan Poe (born January 19, 1809, Boston, Massachusetts, U.S.—died October 7, 1849, Baltimore, Maryland) was an American short-story writer, poet, critic, and editor who is famous for his cultivation of mystery and the macabre. His tale “The Murders in the Rue Morgue” (1841) initiated the modern detective story, and the atmosphere in his tales of horror is unrivaled in American fiction. His “The Raven” (1845) numbers among the best-known poems in the national literature.

Glossary

Unburthen - Archaic form of unburden, meaning to relieve yourself of something causing anxiety, worry or torment.

Phantasm - Sometimes spelled fantasm; it is an illusion or figment of the imagination. Usually within the context of being horrifying or inspiring dread.

Sagacious - Exceptionally wise and insightful.

Paltry - An insignificant amount, often to the degree of challenging one's very self-esteem.

Intemperate - Unrestrained, self-indulgent lack of control.

Malevolence - A malicious intent to inflict wickedness or evil upon others.

Irrevocable - Something that is permanent, unchangeable, and with a conclusion that is certain and unavoidable.

Conflagration - More than a mere fire; an inferno unleashed and out of control.

Fidelity - Intense loyalty and unbound faithfulness to a person, an object, or even an abstract idea or belief.

Chimera - Technically, an ancient mythic monster comprising various body parts of three different animals, but as a metaphor, the word can represent any sort of weird and terrifying phantasm created by a troubled mind.

Bravado - Energetically boastful display of false courage in an attempt to either intimidate a foe or pump up one's own actual courage and determination.

Aversion - A dislike of something so intense that it leads to avoidance.

Perverse - Deviating from the norm to the point of being unnatural.

Hideous - So ugly as to instill fright or revulsion.

Equivocal - Unclear as to meaning; open to interpretation.

Inscrutable - Difficult to understand; conveying a sense of puzzlement based on trickery.

Odious - Disagreeable and unpleasant.

Pertinacious - Exceptionally unwavering and stubborn.

5. THE GIFT OF THE MAGI

1. What were the most precious possessions of Jim and Della?

Jim's most precious possession was his gold pocket watch, a family heirloom. Della's most precious possession was her long, beautiful hair.

2. Why did Della decide to sell her hair?

Della sold her hair to buy a special Christmas gift for Jim, as she did not have enough money otherwise.

3. How much money did Della get for her hair?

Della received \$20 for her hair.

4. What did Della buy for Jim?

Della bought a **platinum fob chain** for Jim's gold watch.

5. What was Jim's Christmas gift for his wife?

Jim gifted Della a set of **beautiful combs** for her long hair.

6. Who are called the Magi in the story? Why are they called so?

Jim and Della are called the **Magi**. They are called so because, like the Wise Men, they gave meaningful gifts out of love and sacrifice.

II. LONG ANSWER

1. How does the writer suggest that Della and Jim are poor?

The writer uses various descriptions and details to show that Della and Jim live in poverty. From the very beginning, O. Henry sets the tone by mentioning that Della had only **\$1.87** to buy a gift for Jim, despite saving for months. The setting of their modest flat is described as small and humble, with "a furnished flat at \$8 per week" and a broken mailbox and doorbell, which further reflect their financial struggles.

Della's act of crying over her limited money and her decision to **sell her beautiful hair** show how desperate she is to express love through a meaningful gift. Similarly, it is later revealed that Jim sold his prized **gold watch**, a family heirloom, to buy combs for Della. This mutual sacrifice highlights not just their love but also their financial limitations. The author subtly uses such small but powerful details to portray the couple's poverty without stating it directly.

2. How is the title of the story significant?

The title "*The Gift of the Magi*" holds deep symbolic meaning. The Magi were the **three wise men** from the East who brought valuable gifts—gold,

frankincense, and myrrh—to baby Jesus. In the story, Jim and Della, though materially poor, show **wisdom, love, and selflessness** by sacrificing their most prized possessions to buy gifts for each other.

Ironically, their gifts become practically useless—Della can't use the combs because she cut her hair, and Jim can't use the chain because he sold his watch. Yet, their actions demonstrate a profound emotional richness. By comparing them to the Magi, the writer suggests that **true wisdom lies in giving selflessly and lovingly**, making Jim and Della the wisest of all gift-givers.

Thus, the title emphasizes the **theme of love, sacrifice, and wisdom**, making it highly significant and meaningful.

3. Comment on the gifts Della and Jim bought for each other.

The gifts that Della and Jim bought for each other are deeply symbolic and reflect their love and devotion. Della bought a **platinum fob chain** for Jim's gold watch, which was his most prized possession. To afford it, she **sold her long, beautiful hair**, which was her own treasure. On the other hand, Jim bought a set of **ornamental combs** for Della's hair, which he could only afford by **selling his watch**.

Although the gifts themselves become useless—the watch chain has no watch, and the combs have no long hair to adorn—their **emotional value** is immense. These gifts represent the **depth of their love and the sacrifices** they are willing to make for each other's happiness. It is the thought and intention behind the gifts that matter more than their utility.

O. Henry uses this irony to highlight that the **true meaning of giving** lies not in the material object, but in the **love, sacrifice, and selflessness** behind it. This makes their gifts the most precious of all.

To His Coy Mistress Summary & Analysis

In the 46 lines of Andrew Marvell's poem "To His Coy Mistress," an anonymous lover attempts to convince his reluctant mistress to have sex with him. The speaker addresses the object of his affection directly, and his monologue takes the form of an argument. He begins by inviting his mistress to imagine that they had all of time at their disposal. If he could devote an eternity to his seduction, then there would be no need for the two of them to hurry. He could court her leisurely and spend years praising every aspect of her beauty. However, since a human being's time on earth is very short, time is of the essence. Instead of deferring their desire, the speaker insists that he and his mistress must consummate their passion now. Over the course of the poem, the speaker develops this argument through a series of elaborate poetic conceits that are often humorous and overstated. In the end, though, his message is quite straightforward: his coy mistress should have sex with him now because life is too short.

To His Coy Mistress Themes

1. The Impossibility of Living Forever

One of the central themes of "To His Coy Mistress" is the truth that life does not last forever. To underscore this theme, the speaker opens the poem by describing a hypothetical vision of what life might be like if humans could indeed live forever. According to this vision, there would never be a need to hurry for anything. In fact, there would be so much time and so little urgency that lovers could spend most if not all their time apart. The speaker makes this point when he envisions his mistress roaming near the Ganges in India while he remains alone, contemplating his love on the banks of the Humber in England. However, the real point of presenting the hypothetical vision of eternal life is to show two things. Firstly, it shows how absurd it is to desire having all the time in the world, since satisfying such a desire is patently impossible. Secondly, it shows that having all the time in the world would actually be deeply unfulfilling, since there would never be a reason to do anything. By contrast, the fact that life comes to an end gives humans a reason to act in the world while we can.

2. The Inevitability of Physical Decline

Just as life is finite, it is also characterized by inevitable physical decline. The speaker addresses the matter of decline in the poem's second stanza, where he remarks to his mistress that, in due time, "Thy beauty shall no more be found" (line 25). In other words, with time comes age, and age diminishes the beauty of youth. But it isn't just beauty that diminishes; the sexual potency of youth also fades with time. The speaker tells his mistress that, just as her beauty will no more be found, "Nor, in thy marble vault, shall sound / My echoing song" (lines 26–27). These lines have a double meaning. On the one hand, they indicate that when they are both dead, he will no longer be able to sing songs of praise to her. On the other hand, the lines suggest that, even before they have died, his "song" (i.e., his sexual performance) will no longer take place in her "marble vault" (i.e., her vagina). These forms of decline are an inevitable result of what the speaker refers to as time's "slow-chapped power" (line 40).

3. The Vitality of the Present Moment

In the face of time's devouring jaws, the speaker argues that the only thing to do is make the best use of the present moment. It is for this reason that, after spending two stanzas exploring the impossibility of eternal life and the inevitability of death, he returns to the vitality of the present. The third stanza opens with the following lines (lines 33–37):

*Now therefore, while the youthful hue
Sits on thy skin like morning dew,
And while thy willing soul transpires
At every pore with instant fires,
Now let us sport us while we may.*

Note the repeated use of the word "now" in the first and last lines, which the speaker emphasizes to draw attention to the present moment. Also note the use of the present tense. The speaker describes his mistress's skin as it is in this moment, glistening with a youthful glow. From this observation he infers that, at this very moment, she is burning with desire for him. The inevitable threat of death that the speaker discussed in the second stanza brings the immediacy of their desire into stark relief. Just as mortality confers meaning on life, it also endows the present with a greater sense of immediacy.

4. Love

"To His Coy Mistress" is basically a love poem. Like most other metaphysical poems, this also deals with love, beauty, Sexuality etc. The speaker wants to make love as soon as possible. In exaggerated traditional references of lovemaking, the speaker expresses how much he loves his coy mistress. But the lady is here not responding to the lover's call. So, the speaker-lover is desperately trying to convince her to make love with him without wasting time, as they are at their height of youth now.

The love expressed here is more physical and sensual than spiritual, as we generally see in Donne's metaphysical poems like The Flea, The Good Morrow etc.

Lines 1–4

Had we but world enough and time,
This coyness, lady, were no crime.
We would sit down, and think which way
To walk, and pass our long love's day.

Andrew Marvell's famous metaphysical love poem "To His Coy Mistress" begins with the speaker talking to his shy ladylove (coy mistress). He opines that if they had plenty of time and space in this world to live, then her shyness would not be considered a crime. So, the speaker calls his ladylove's present shyness a crime.

The speaker adds that if they had enough time in their hand, then they would sit together somewhere and would plan the ways in which they can spend their time. They would plan how they would walk or how they would pass the "long love's day".

So, in these opening lines of the poem, the speaker seems to be trying to convince his 'coy mistress' about the mortality of human life. Moreover, he is talking about love. Let's read on to know further.

Lines 5–10

Thou by the Indian Ganges' side
Shouldst rubies find; I by the tide
Of Humber would complain. I would
Love you ten years before the flood,
And you should, if you please, refuse
Till the conversion of the Jews.

Well, the speaker continues the same argument here. He would imagine the condition if they had a limitless life. If they had enough time, his beloved would sit beside the river Ganga in India and collect some valuable stones like rubies. On the other hand, the speaker would sit on bank of river Humber complaining to the river about her beloved not coming to him. Thus, they would pass the days.

In the next line, the speaker expresses how much he would love his beloved if they had enough time. He says he would love his mistress for "ten years before the flood". This alludes to the Great Flood in Christian history. Also, his mistress could refuse his proposal until the "Conversion of the Jews", which refers to the day of Christian judgment prophesied for the end of times in the new testament's Book of Revelation. He would not mind as they will have enough time to make love.

Lines 11–14

My vegetable love should grow
Vaster than empires and more slow;
A hundred years should go to praise
Thine eyes, and on thy forehead gaze;

In the next line, the speaker claims that his love is a "vegetable love". He compares his love with vegetable because his love grows slowly and organically, without any external force. The speaker then suggests that if time permitted, his love would grow more than the width of an empire and its growth will be very gradual.

Then the speaker goes on to describe how he would have praised each and every part of his beloved's body if he had enough time to live. He says he would have consumed a hundred years in praising her eyes and gazing at her forehead.

Lines 15–20

Two hundred to adore each breast,
But thirty thousand to the rest;
An age at least to every part,
And the last age should show your heart.
For, lady, you deserve this state,
Nor would I love at lower rate.

In a continuation from the previous lines, the lover would take two hundred years to adore each of his ladylove's breasts. Also, he would take thirty thousand years for praising rest of her body. The speaker claims that he would have consumed a lifetime to praise each part of her beloved's body. He will concentrate on her heart at the very end.

Lines 21–24

But at my back I always hear
Time's wingèd chariot hurrying near;
And yonder all before us lie
Deserts of vast eternity.

Here begins the second section of the poem. In the first section, the speaker was talking about the possibilities of the extent of love that they could enjoy if they had a limitless life in this world. But alas! It is impossible. He says that he hears the sound of the time's wings as it flies closely behind their backs. Time waits for no one. It flies, leaving everything behind.

He also says that the other world (after death) is waiting for us at a distance (yonder). It's like a vast desert of eternity lying before us. Thus, the lover reminds his beloved of life's brevity (shortness).

Lines 25–28

Thy beauty shall no more be found;
Nor, in thy marble vault, shall sound
My echoing song; then worms shall try
That long-preserved virginity,

Here the speaker describes the situation after death. In our destined tomb, our beauty will slowly but surely turn into dust. So, the beloved's beauty will fade as soon as she dies. Here "marble vault" refers to coffin. The speaker's song would not be heard from her coffin. Everything will vanish and turn to dust there.

After mentioning the beloved's beauty, the speaker speaks of her virginity that she has preserved for a long time. The worms would destroy this long-preserved virginity there in the coffin. Thus, we see, the speaker tries to make his lady realize that things like beauty and virginity are of no use after death.

Lines 29–32

And your quaint honour turn to dust,
And into ashes all my lust;
The grave's a fine and private place,
But none, I think, do there embrace.

Not only her virginity, but also her honour will turn to dust. All that honour for which she has saved her virginity will be attacked by worms. At the same time, his lust for her beauty too will turn into ashes. Though the lover finds the grave a "fine and private place" as nobody can't see them there, it's not the place where lovers should "embrace".

Lines 33–37

Now therefore, while the youthful hue
Sits on thy skin like morning dew,
And while thy willing soul transpires
At every pore with instant fires,
Now let us sport us while we may,

The last section starts with "now therefore". It means the speaker will now talk about the things they need to do right now before the time flies. He says that youth is the best part of the life to enjoy. At this time, one becomes energetic and passionate. The skin is as fresh as the morning dew.

Moreover, in her youth, the beloved's soul is very much willing to come out (transpire) from every pore of the skin with immediate desires. The speaker here is actually talking about his lady's erotic desires which he believes he can see in her body. So, he suggests that they should indulge in physical lovemaking ('sport' hints at a sexual play) without wasting time. This is like making hay while the sun shines.

Lines 38–40

And now, like amorous birds of prey,
Rather at once our time devour
Than languish in his slow-chapped power.

The speaker now suggests that the two lovers should be like passionate (amorous) preying birds (like eagle, hawk etc.) and eat (devour) time before time eats them. He means to say that

unless the lovers enjoy their time at their youthful heights, time won't wait for them and they will slowly suffer (languish) the destructing power of time.

Lines 41–46

Let us roll all our strength and all
Our sweetness up into one ball,
And tear our pleasures with rough strife
Through the iron gates of life:
Thus, though we cannot make our sun
Stand still, yet we will make him run.

The speaker now suggests that they should unite all their strength and passion along with their sweetness to get the pleasure of love. Life is just an iron gate that doesn't open easily. It is filled with struggle and resentment (rough strife). With all their strength and passion, the lovers will tear the iron gate to get that happiness.

In the last couplet, the poet wants to say that they can't make their good times of youth wait for them. However, they can make the most of their time with love's untidiness. It would be a fitting challenge to the running of time then.

Setting

In "To His Coy Mistress", no particular setting is found. The overall poem takes place in the speaker's imagination. But the poet mentions the name of some places. The speaker imagines himself and his mistress wandering across the whole earth, from the river Humber (East Yorkshire) in England to the Ganges in India. Most of the poem talks about love and sexuality. So, we may think that the speaker and his mistress could be any lovers living in any setting.

To His Coy Mistress — Literary Devices

Alliteration

Alliteration is a sub-category of consonance. It is the repetition of consonant sounds in the beginning (or, stressed syllables) of nearby words.

We would sit down, and think **w**hich **w**ay

Sits on thy **s**kin like morning dew,

Simile

A simile is a direct comparison between two things using 'as' or 'like'.

Now therefore, while the youthful hue

Sits on thy skin **like morning dew**,

In the above lines (33-34), the speaker compares his lady's youthful beauty and freshness to the morning dew using a simile.

And now, **like amorous birds of prey**

In line 38 of "To His Coy Mistress", the speaker-lover compares themselves to passionate preying birds who can eat time before time eats them.

Metaphor

A metaphor is an indirect or implied comparison between two things where there is a point of similarity.

My vegetable love should grow

In line 11, the speaker implicitly compares his love to vegetables for its slower development.

Time's wingèd chariot hurrying near;

In line 22, time is indirectly compared to a winged chariot. Time waits for none and it flies swiftly and hence this comparison.

Deserts of vast eternity.

Again, in line 24, eternity is compared to a desert. We have no idea of the other world after death. That is why it seems barren and like a desert to us.

Personification

Personification is a literary device in which human qualities are attributed to non-human things.

In Andrew Marvell's poem "To His Coy Mistress", time has been personified on more than one occasion.

Time's **wingèd chariot hurrying** near;

In the above line, time is seen driving his winged chariot as if he is a human being.

Rather at once our time devour

Than languish in **his slow-chapped power**.

In the above lines, the speaker uses the pronoun 'his' for time and speaks of its slow engulfing power.

Thus, though we cannot make our sun

Stand still, yet we will **make him run**.

Again, in the final lines of the poem, the lover uses 'him' for sun and talks of making him run. All there are examples of personification.

Imagery

Imageries are used to make the readers perceive things with their five senses.

Thou by the Indian Ganges' side

Time's wingèd chariot hurrying near;

Visual imageries are used in the above lines. We can visualize the ladylove sitting on the riverbank and the flying chariot hurrying behind us.

Allusion

An allusion is an indirect reference to something which is literally, historically or culturally important. In Marvell's "To His Coy Mistress", there are allusions of the river Humber in England and the Ganges in India.

Thou by the **Indian Ganges'** side
Shouldst rubies find; I by the tide
Of **Humber** would complain...

Again, there are Biblical allusions of the Great Flood and the Conversion of the Jews.

Love you ten years before **the flood**,
And you should, if you please, refuse
Till the **conversion of the Jews**.

In line 22, the speaker also alludes to the mythological winged chariot driven by the sun god Helios. **Time's wingèd chariot** hurrying near;

Hyperbole

Hyperbole is an exaggerated statement or claim that is not meant to be taken literally.

In the poem "To His Coy Mistress", the speaker reaches the heights of exaggeration when he says that he would take one hundred years to praise and gaze at his lady's eyes and forehead, two hundred years to adore each of her breasts and thirty thousand years for the rest of her body.

A **hundred years** should go to praise
Thine eyes, and on thy forehead gaze;
Two hundred to adore each breast,
But **thirty thousand** to the rest;

Again, this is an obvious overstatement when the speaker says that he would make the sun run.

Thus, though we cannot make our sun
Stand still, yet we will **make him run**.

Detailed Analysis of 'To his Coy Mistress'

Lines 1-20

In these first lines, there are ten couplets, and mimics a traditional format – in this case, the poem itself, although written in the form of a love poem, does not aspire to such lofty heights; the gentleman wishes only for his lady to give in to his sexual advances, and so the use of the traditional love elegy format (otherwise known as 'carpe diem' poetry) might seem as though it is ironically used. However, given that this was written at a time when such emotion was not freely expressed, the beauty of the language and the overwhelming focus on the woman's beauty, the respect is shown therein, makes the poem quite progressive for its time.

The man begins by explaining, to his lady, how he would go about worshipping her if he had the time. He turns their love into far more than the poem can hold by using expressions such as 'love you ten years before the Flood', thus allegorizing it in almost Biblical terms, 'vegetable love', which shows how slow and how steady it grows (hinting, as always, at a huge advancement), and then stating that 'a hundred years' would be spent on praising her: her eyes, her forehead, two hundred years to worship her breasts, and 'thirty thousand to the rest'. Above all, *To His Coy Mistress* does not denigrate or mock the lady's appearance (such as in Shakespeare's 'My Mistress' Eyes are Nothing Like the Sun') as this was not the use of metaphysical poetry. The use of what is known as an erotic blazon – taken directly from Petrarchan love poetry – deifies the lady of the speaker's affection; this is the truest form of love that the man feels as though he can manage.

Lines 21-32

In the next lines, the mood of *To His Coy Mistress* swings abruptly. In the first, there was little haste or rush; the poet took his time describing the woman's beauty, and all the ways that she deserved to be worshipped, producing, therefore, a flowing, relaxed poem that does not rush itself to the end. By these lines, however, the mood shifts, and the poet is at once pleading and urgent, telling the lady that he hears 'time's winged chariot hurrying near' (alluding to Greek mythology, another form of deifying his lady love).

Here, the poet, though no less praising of his woman's beauty, tells her that he does not have the time to worship her as he sees fit; time is always hurrying closer and closer. 'Deserts of vast eternity' await them, and her beauty will fade, her virginity will 'turn to dust' along with her

honour, and all the waiting will be, it is implied, for naught. The feeling of foreboding, although light, is definitely there.

Lines 33-46

However, in the last set of lines, the mood brightens again; the poet has a solution! They should embrace each other now, while they have the time, be together now when they are young and beautiful, and not think about the future. 'Now let us sport while we may', says the poet, urging his lady love to listen to him – 'sport' is a commonly used word, in the 17th century, for sex. He compares them to 'amorous birds of prey', thus showing the natural and impulsive urges of their nature – at once, they are both elevated above man and below him.

The last few lines take on the imagery of roiling passion: the poet wants to 'tear our pleasures with rough strife / through the iron gates of life', thus somehow elevating their own passion above life itself. Note that the last set of lines is the most poetically proficient of all things, and though the feeling is very much a plea to not waste the time that they have, the poet maintains a light-hearted tone through to the end.

ODE TO THE WEST WIND

- Percy Bysshe Shelley

Synopsis

- ◆ INTRODUCTION
- ◆ SHORT BIOGRAPHY OF SHELLEY
- ◆ SUMMARY OF ODE TO THE WEST WIND
- ◆ FORM OF THE POEM
- ◆ THEMES
- ◆ CONCLUSION

INTRODUCTION

The West Wind in Shelley's ode is depicted as an autumnal wind, preparing the world for winter. As a result, the poem is filled with images of death and decay, reminders of both natural and human mortality. The speaker hopes that the death of one world will be inevitably followed by a new rebirth and a new spring, but the poem leaves this rebirth uncertain. This poem shows Shelley's love with nature rather than political and society inspiration which is major area of Shelley in his early period.

SHORT BIOGRAPHY OF SHELLEY

Percy Bysshe Shelley is one of the epic poets of the 19th century, born in Broadbridge Heath, just outside of West Sussex, England, on August 4, 1792 and is best known for his classic anthology verse works such as Ode to the West Wind and The Masque of Anarchy. He is also well known for his long-form poetry, including Queen Mab and Alastor. Shelley and his friend Thomas Jefferson Hogg had co-authored a pamphlet titled *The Necessity of Atheism*. He went on many adventures with his second wife, Mary Shelley, the author of Frankenstein. He drowned in a sudden storm while sailing in Italy in 1822.

Some major works:

Queen Mab

Ozymandias

Adonais

To a skylark

Defence of poetry

The Triumph of Life

Julian and Maddalo

England in 1819

Prometheus Unbound

SUMMARY OF THE POEM

- ❖ In the first stanza, the wind blows the leaves of autumn.
- ❖ In the second stanza, the wind blows the clouds in the sky.
- ❖ In the third stanza, the wind blows across an island and the waves of the sea.
- ❖ In the fourth stanza, the persona imagines being the leaf, cloud, or wave, sharing in the wind's strength. He desires to be lifted up rather than caught low on "the thorns of life," for he sees himself as like the wind: "tameless, and swift, and proud."
- ❖ In the final stanza, he asks the wind to play upon him like a lyre; he wants to share the wind's fierce spirit. In turn, he would have the power to spread his verse throughout the world, reawakening it.

The poet is directing his speech to the wind and all that it has the power to do as it takes charge of the rest of nature and blows across the earth and through the seasons, able both to preserve and to destroy all in its path.

"Wild Spirit, which art moving everywhere;

Destroyer and Preserver; hear, O hear!"

The speaker invokes the "wild West Wind" of autumn, which scatters the dead leaves and spreads seeds so that they may be nurtured by the spring, and asks that the wind, a "destroyer and preserver," hear him. The speaker calls the wind the "dirge / Of the dying year," and describes how it stirs up violent storms, and again implores it to hear him.

The speaker says that if he were a dead leaf that the wind could bear, or a cloud it could carry, or a wave it could push, or even if he were, as a boy, "the comrade" of the wind's "wandering

over heaven,” then he would never have needed to pray to the wind and invoke its powers. The wind takes control over clouds, seas, weather, and more.

“The blue Mediterranean, where he lay,

Lulled by the coil of his chrystalline streams,”

The poet offers that the wind over the Mediterranean Sea was an inspiration for the poem. He says that the wind stirs the Mediterranean from “his summer dreams,” and cleaves the Atlantic into choppy chasms, making the “sapless foliage” of the ocean tremble, and asks for a third time that it hear him.

Recognizing its power, the wind becomes a metaphor for nature’s awe-inspiring spirit. By the final stanza, the speaker has come to terms with the wind’s power over him, and he requests inspiration and subjectivity. He looks to nature’s power to assist him in his work of poetry and prays that the wind will deliver his words across the land and through time as it does with all other objects in nature.

‘Make me thy lyre, even as the forest is’

The speaker asks the wind to “make me thy lyre,” to be his own Spirit, and to drive his thoughts across the universe, “like withered leaves, to quicken a new birth.” He asks the wind, by the incantation of this verse, to scatter his words among mankind, to be the “trumpet of a prophecy.” Speaking both in regard to the season and in regard to the effect upon mankind that he hopes his words to have, the speaker asks:

“If winter comes, can spring be far behind?”

FORM OF THE POEM

Each stanza is fourteen lines in length, using the rhyming pattern of aba bcb cdc ded ee. This is called terza rima, the form used by Dante in his *Divine Comedy*.

THEME OF THE POEM

- **Preservation**
- **Destruction**

- **Seasonal cycle**
- **Power of nature**
- **Man and the natural world**
- **Hope of human life**
- **Freedom of human life**

This poem is about the inspiration Shelley draws from nature. The “breath of autumn being” is Shelley’s atheistic version of the Christian Holy Spirit. Instead of relying on traditional religion, Shelley focuses his praise around the wind’s role in the various cycles in nature—death, regeneration, “preservation,” and “destruction.” The speaker begins by praising the wind, using anthropomorphic techniques (wintry bed, chariots, corpses, and clarions) to personalize the great natural spirit in hopes that it will somehow heed his plea. The speaker is aware of his own mortality and the immortality of his subject. This drives him to beg that he too can be inspired (“make me thy lyre”) and carried (“be through my lips to unawakened earth”) through land and time.

Maybe the wind can even help him to send his ideas all over the world; even if they’re not powerful in their own right, his ideas might inspire others. The sad music that the wind will play on him will become a prophecy.

The first two stanzas are mere praise for the wind’s power, covered in simile and allusion to all that which the wind has the power to do: “loosen,” “spread,” “shed,” and “burst.” In the fourth and fifth stanzas, the speaker enters into the poem, seeking (hoping) for equal treatment along with all other objects in nature, at least on the productive side. The poet offers humility in the hope that the wind will assist him in achieving his quest to “drive [his] dead thoughts over the universe.” Ultimately, the poet is thankful for the inspiration he is able to draw from nature’s spirit, and he hopes that it will also be the same spirit that carries his words across the land where he also can be a source of inspiration.

CONCLUSION

The poem appeals to the West Wind to infuse him with a new spirit and a new power to spread his ideas. In order to invoke the West Wind, he lists a series of things the wind has done that illustrate its power: driving away the autumn leaves, placing seeds in the earth, bringing thunderstorms and the cyclical “death” of the natural world, and stirring up the seas and oceans. The speaker wishes that the wind could affect him the way it does leaves and clouds and waves. Because it can’t, he asks the wind to play him like an instrument, bringing out his sadness in its own musical lament.

3. QUALITY OF MERCY

I. TWO MARKS

1. Mercy is compared to gentle rain from heaven . How is this comparison apt ?

As the gentle rain falls on the earth , so also when mercy is shown it blesses the giver and the taker and given comfort .

2. The speaker compares the power of the king with the power of mercy , saying that mercy is the mightiest of the mightiest . How does she justify this ?

The king who has sceptre in his hand evokes a feeling of fear in the minds of others but the king who has a feeling of mercy in his heart possesses divine quality of mercy .

3. The poem ' Quality of Mercy ' has fourteen lines . But it is not a sonnet . Justify the statement .

This poem consists of fourteen lines but it is not a sonnet as there is no rhyme , scheme in the poem. In other words there aren't three quatrains and a couple .

4.What is meant by 'mercy seasons justice'?OR What happens when mercy is tempered with justice?

The phrase 'mercy seasons justice' can be interpreted in different ways as the word 'seasons' has different meanings. It can mean flavours, tempers, enhances etc. Interestingly all meanings fit the context. It can be said that justice gets enhanced and becomes more attractive if it goes hand-in-hand with mercy. If the judgement, even if it is the right one, is too harsh, it should be made more moderate or temperate with mercy.

5.What does the sceptre show?

A sceptre is a decorated rod carried by a king as a symbol of power. It represents his earthly power, the symbol of majesty, the focus of royal authority. The sceptre shows the level of his temporal power – the symbol of awe and majesty in which lies the source of the dread and fear that kings command.

II .FIVE MARKS

1. How does the speaker in the court try to convince Shylock that mercy is twice blessed and is a divine quality ? OR What does Portia tell Shylock about the quality of Mercy ?

*Upon the place beneath: it is twice blest;
It blesseth him that gives and him that takes."*

Context: These lines are spoken by *Portia*, disguised as a young lawyer, in the courtroom scene of *The Merchant of Venice*. She is addressing *Shylock*, the Jewish moneylender, pleading with him to show mercy toward *Antonio*, who has failed to repay his debt.

Explanation: Portia begins by saying that mercy cannot be forced ("not strained"), meaning true mercy must come from the heart, not obligation. She compares mercy to "gentle rain from heaven," suggesting that it is natural, pure, and life-giving. Just as rain nourishes the earth without being commanded, mercy should flow freely from one person to another.

She then explains that mercy is "twice blest"—it blesses both the giver and the receiver. The one who shows mercy experiences the joy of kindness, and the one who receives mercy is relieved from suffering. This idea highlights the moral superiority of mercy over strict justice.

*2. "It is an attribute to God himself;
And earthly power doth then show likest God's
When mercy seasons justice."*

Context: Portia, disguised as a lawyer, continues her plea to *Shylock*, trying to persuade him to show mercy to *Antonio*. She explains that mercy is a divine quality, and rulers who balance justice with mercy reflect God's nature.

Explanation: Portia states that mercy is a divine quality, belonging to "God himself." This means that those who show mercy act in a godlike manner. She argues that rulers (or those in power) are at their greatest when they temper justice with mercy. "Season" suggests adding flavor, implying that justice alone is harsh and incomplete without the softening effect of mercy.

She implies that power is best used when it does not just punish but also forgives. Instead of viewing justice and mercy as opposites, Shakespeare presents them as complementary forces—true justice is enhanced when mercy is included.

3. "Therefore, Jew,
Though justice be thy plea, consider this,
That in the course of justice none of us
Should see salvation."

Context: In this part of the speech, Portia directly addresses Shylock, urging him to think beyond the law and consider the moral implications of his actions. She argues that strict justice, without mercy, would be too harsh for humanity. This is an attempt to appeal to Shylock's conscience and persuade him to show compassion.

Explanation: Portia acknowledges that Shylock is asking for justice—he is legally entitled to claim Antonio's pound of flesh. However, she warns him that if justice were applied strictly to everyone, no one would be saved. She refers to the Christian belief that human beings are flawed and that salvation comes through divine mercy, not justice alone.

Her point is that human law should reflect this divine principle: just as God forgives sinners, people should forgive each other. She implies that if Shylock insists on absolute justice, he should expect the same treatment from others, which could ultimately harm him.

The Unknown Citizen Summary:

How much control should the government have over its citizens' lives? How much conformity is beneficial to society and how much is a detrimental loss of a sense of self? W. H. Auden asks all these questions and more in his 1940 poem "The Unknown Citizen." In his extreme case of government control, a man's life is evaluated entirely upon how he conformed to society's expectations in his occupation, family, and even his opinions. Told in a cold, detached tone as if taken straight out of a government report, the poem will make you question how the government and conformity intersect and what effect that has on society. The Unknown Citizen

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Summary

'*The Unknown Citizen* by W.H. Auden describes, through the form of a dystopian report, the life of an unknown man.

The poem begins with the speaker stating the fact that throughout his life there was never one "complaint" against the citizen. No one thought badly of him, in fact, he was more like a "saint" than anything else. The next section of the poem tells of the man's popularity. He was well-liked by his friends, social enough to be normal, and dedicated to his work. The man served the "Community" for his entire life. The only lapse in his work for his company was when he went to serve in the "War," and now, after he has died.

The speaker also states that the man read the newspapers to a sufficient degree. He went to the hospital once, but left quickly, "cured," as he should have been. The citizen consumed all the latest technologies, as a "Modern Man" should, and owned the proper devices.

In the final section of the poem, the speaker concludes his report. He states that the man was "for" war when he was supposed to be, and for "peace," when the government told him to be. The last lines prompt the questions a reader might have been wondering the whole time. Was this man happy? Was he free? These are things that the speaker sees as "absurd." He states that, of course, the man was happy, the government would have "known" if he wasn't.

Analysis of *The Unknown Citizen*

Lines 1-5

He was found by the Bureau of Statistics to be
One against whom there was no official complaint,
And all the reports of his conduct agree
That, in the modern sense of the old-fashioned word, he was a saint,
For in everything he did he served the Greater Community.

Auden has chosen to craft a speaker for the "Unknown Citizen" who is completely concealed, but strangely familiar. He speaks with a candidness and emotionless tenor which is hard to connect with. Once the identity of the speaker is a bit clearer though, one might come to recognize the faceless, seemingly lifeless person of a government worker or customer service representative.

The speaker is going about his job, as he would any other day, and is not impacted by the facts he is relaying about the "unknown citizen." The speaker's lack of inflection is made up for by the rhymes which are pervasive in his speech.

It was Auden's goal in this piece to present the words of a dystopian narrator, to the tune of a rhyme. This contrast is quite forceful as the reader will discover throughout the poem's 32 lines.

The speaker begins by introducing the main subject of the poem, who will never receive a name or proper identification. The reader will only come to know him through the facts that the "Bureau of Statistics," "the Greater Community," and other fictional dystopian sounding organizations, have seen fit to share.

The first thing of note that the speaker mentions is that there are no "complaints" lodged against this person. No one stepped forward, during their investigation, to say that he had done some wrong. All of the reports that this speaker has at

his disposal tell him that the “unknown citizen” is a “saint.” His record is spotless and pristine.

This poem certainly reads like a report and it is interesting to consider why these particular facts about this person’s life were chosen. What do these things really tell about someone? It is important to note that there is nothing deeper discussed in these lines. One cannot come to fully know the “unknown citizen” through this report, hence the irony between the title and the goal of the verses.

Lines 6-14

Except for the War till the day he retired
He worked in a factory and never got fired,
But satisfied his employers, Fudge Motors Inc.
Yet he wasn’t a scab or odd in his views,
For his Union reports that he paid his dues,
(Our report on his Union shows it was sound)
And our Social Psychology workers found
(...)
The Press are convinced that he bought a paper every day

In the second set of lines, the report continues. Throughout the “unknown citizen’s” life, he did a number of things to serve the community. In fact, he spent his whole life “serv[ing] the Greater Community.” Capitalization is utilized throughout the poem to acknowledge bodies, or official groups that exist in the world of the poem. The citizen served the community up until the day he died. The only exception was when he went to fight in the “War.” Which war this is meant to be is not made clear.

The citizen worked in a factory and never got fired, But satisfied his employers,
Fudge Motors Inc.

The man did as he was told, dedicated himself to his work, and was continually in the good graces of his employers. So far this person seems incredibly straightforward. There is not much more revealed besides surface-level details that anyone could infer.

The man did not have any “odd views” and he always paid his “union dues.” He was on time with payments and was not strange in any way. That is to say, he did

not believe in, or participate in anything, that went against the tenants of this dystopian feeling world.

The man not only did well at work, but he was also popular with his friends. They were social and completely normal. One might at this point be suspicious of the total normalcy that filled this person's life. Shouldn't there be more there to see and learn about?

Lines 15-22

And that his reactions to advertisements were normal in every way.
Policies taken out in his name prove that he was fully insured,
(...)

A gramophone, a radio, a car and a frigidaire.
Our researchers into Public Opinion are content

The poem continues and the speaker refers to a number of other organizations that have been keeping an eye on the citizen. The "Press," presumably a government-run news organization, reported to the speaker that the citizen, bought a paper every day and that his reactions to advertisements were normal in every way.

The man was as susceptible to advertising as he was supposed to be, and committed to the news of the day. Continuing in the theme of this dystopia, it is quite likely his life was consumed with the propaganda produced by these agencies. It is hard to know who this person truly was with these purely surface-level details.

Additionally, the man went to the hospital, but did not stay long. He left "cured" just as he should. He was sufficiently healthy and sufficiently interested in acquiring all the appliances a "Modern Man" would need. He had, a phonograph, a radio, a car and a Frigidaire.

Lines 23-29

That he held the proper opinions for the time of the year;
When there was peace he was for peace; when there was war he went.
(...)

Was he free? Was he happy? The question is absurd:
Had anything been wrong, we should certainly have heard.

In the final section of this piece the speaker concludes his report on the "unknown citizen." The researchers at "Public Opinion," perhaps the government organization the speaker works for as he uses, "Our," conclude that the man had all the "proper opinions." The propaganda was doing its job and the man believed what he was meant to. He was an advocate for what the government told him to be, whether the was "peace" or "war."

The man's personal life consisted of a normal wife, and "five children" that were "added...to the population." The number was not too many or too few, it was just "right" for a man of his "generation."

The final lines of the piece bring greater attention to the absurdity of the poem's premise. The speaker, as if defending himself, states that the "question" of whether the citizen was "free" or "happy" is absurd. He was certainly happy, otherwise, "we should...have heard."

W. H. Auden: Poems Summary and Analysis of "The Unknown Citizen"

The poem begins with an ironic epigraph, "To JS/07 M 378 / This Marble Monument / Is Erected by the State."

The Bureau of Statistics and all other reports show that he will complied with his duties to "the Greater Community." He worked in a factory and paid his union dues. He had no odd views. The Social Psychology investigators found him to be normal, as did the Press: he was popular, "liked a drink," bought the daily paper, and had the "normal" reactions to advertisements. He was fully insured. The Health-card report shows he was in the hospital only once, and left cured.

The Producers Research and High-Grade Living investigators also showed he was normal and "had everything necessary to the Modern Man"—radio, car, etcetera. The Public Opinion researchers found "he held the proper opinions for the time of year," supporting peace in peacetime but serving when there was war. He was married and had the appropriate number of five children, according to the Eugenicist. He never interfered with the public schools. It is absurd to ask whether he was free or happy, for if anything had been wrong, "we should certainly have heard."

Analysis

"The Unknown Citizen" (1940) is one of Auden's most famous poems. Often anthologized and read by students in high school and college, it is renowned for its wit and irony in complaining about the stultifying and anonymous qualities of bureaucratic, semi-socialist Western societies. Its structure is that of a satiric elegy, as though the boring, unknown citizen was so utterly unremarkable that the state honored him with a poetic monument about how little trouble he caused for anyone. It resembles the "Unknown Soldier" memorials that nations erect to honor the soldiers who fought and died for their countries and whose names have been lost to posterity; Britain's is located in Westminster Abbey and the United States' is located in Arlington, Virginia. This one, in an unnamed location, lists the unknown man as simply "JS/07 M 378."

Auden's "Unknown Citizen" is not anonymous like the Unknown Soldier, for the bureaucracy knows a great deal about him. The named agencies give the sense, as early as 1940, that a powerful Big Brother kind of bureaucracy watches over its citizens and collects data on them and keeps it throughout one's life. This feeling makes the poem eerie and prescient; one often thinks of the dystopian, totalitarian states found in the writings of George Orwell and Aldous Huxley or the data-driven surveillance state of today. In Auden's context, one might think of the state-focused governments of Hitler, Stalin, and Mussolini.

The Big Brother perspective begins from the very outset of the poem, with its evocation of a Bureau of Statistics. The man has had every aspect of his life catalogued. He served his community, he held a job, he paid union dues, he did not hold radical views, he reacted normally to advertisements, he had insurance, he possessed the right material goods, he had proper opinions about current events, and he married and had the right amount of children. It does not appear on paper that he did anything wrong or out of place. In fact, "he was a saint" from the state's perspective, having "served the Greater Community." The words used to describe him—"normal," "right," "sensible," "proper," "popular"—indicate that he is considered the ideal citizen. He is praised as "unknown" because there was nothing interesting to know. Consider, in comparison, the completely normalized protagonist Emmet in *The Lego Movie*.

At the end of the poem, the closing couplet asks, "Was he free? Was he happy? The question is absurd: / Had anything been wrong, we should certainly have

heard." With these last lines comes the deeper meaning of the poem, the irony that despite all of the bureaucratic data gathering, some aspect of the individual might not have been captured. It becomes clear that the citizen is also "unknown" because in this statistical gathering of data, the man's individuality and identity are lost. This bureaucratic society, focused on its official view of the common good, assesses a person using external, easily-catalogued characteristics rather than respect for one's uniqueness, one's particular thoughts, feelings, hopes, fears, and goals.

Interestingly, and ironically, the speaker himself is also unknown. The professionals in the poem— "his employers," "our Social Psychology workers," "our researchers into Public Opinion," "our Eugenacist"— are just as anonymous and devoid of personality. While a person might be persuaded that he is free or happy, the evidence of his life shows that he is just one more cog in the faceless, nameless bureaucratic machine.

5. COROMANDAL FISHERS – SAROJINI NAIDU.

I. Two marks question and answers.

1. Who is “us”? To whom is he speaking?

“Us” stands for the Coromandel fishers. The speaker is one of the fishermen who is addressing his comrades.

2. To whom is the poem The Coromandel Fishers addressed to?

The poem “The Coromandel Fishers” is addressed to the Indian fisher folk.

3. What is Sarojini Naidu famously known as?

Sarojini Naidu is famously known by the sobriquet “the Nightingale of India

4. Who is the speaker in the poem? Whom does he address?

The speaker is one of the fishermen, and he is addressing his fellow fishermen, urging them to rise and go to the sea.

5. Why does the speaker call his fellow men to rise?

The speaker calls his fellow fishermen to rise early in the morning so they can set out to the sea and begin their day’s work of fishing.

6. What is the wind compared to in the poem?

The wind is compared to a child that has cried all night and is now asleep.

7. To whom do the fishermen offer their prayer?

The fishermen offer their prayer to the Sea God, asking for protection and blessings during their journey.

8. What is the ‘leaping wealth of the tide’?:

The ‘leaping wealth of the tide’ refers to the jumping fish in the sea, which are the source of livelihood for the fishermen.

6. Pick the words that show the close relationship of fishermen with nature.

Words like **"the wind lies asleep," "the sea is our mother," "the cloud is our brother," "the waves are our comrades"** show the deep bond and close relationship of the fishermen with nature.

7. What do the fishermen love on the shore?

The fishermen love **the shade of the coconut glade, the scent of the mango grove, and the sands at their feet** on the shore.

8. Which phrases in the poem suggest that the fishermen love the sea more than the shore?

Phrases like **"the sea is our mother," "the sea is our comrades," and "the kiss of the spray and the dance of the wild foam's glee"** suggest that the fishermen have a deeper love and connection with the sea than the shore.

II. REFERENCE TO CONTEXT

***1. "Rise, brothers, rise! the wakening skies
pray to the morning light,
The wind lies asleep in the arms of the dawn
like a child that has cried all night."***

Context: These lines are from the poem *The Coromandel Fishers* by Sarojini Naidu. The poem is an inspiring call to the fishermen, encouraging them to wake up and set out to the sea with enthusiasm. It also reflects their deep connection with nature.

Explanation:

The poet addresses the fishermen as 'brothers' and urges them to wake up. She describes the morning scene where the sky is waking up, symbolizing a new beginning. The wind, which was strong at night, is now calm, like a child who has cried and is now resting. This imagery conveys peace and readiness for the day's work. The poet's words also emphasize the fishermen's courage and their dependence on the sea for survival.

**2."No longer delay, let us hasten away
In the track of the seagull's call,
The sea is our mother, the cloud is our brother,
The waves are our comrades all."**

Context: *These lines are from The Coromandel Fishers, a poem by Sarojini Naidu. Here, the poet encourages the fishermen to set out to the sea without delay. The poem highlights their deep connection with nature and their adventurous spirit.*

Explanation: *The poet tells the fishermen to hurry and follow the seagull, which acts as a guide to the sea. She describes the sea as their "mother," showing its nurturing and life-giving qualities. The "cloud" is called their "brother," representing companionship and protection, while the "waves" are their "comrades," showing their unity with the ocean. These metaphors emphasize the strong relationship between the fishermen and nature.*

**3."Sweet is the shade of the coconut glade,
And the scent of the mango grove,
And sweet are the sands at the full o' the moon
With the sound of the voices we love."**

Context: *These lines appear in the middle of the poem, where the poet acknowledges the beauty of the land. She describes the comforting and familiar aspects of the fishermen's home but reminds them that their true calling is the sea.*

Explanation: *The poet describes the "shade of the coconut glade" and the "scent of the mango grove" to highlight the peaceful and pleasant environment of the land. She also talks about the joy of being with loved ones. However, despite these comforts, the fishermen must leave and return to the sea, which is their real home. This contrast between land and sea emphasizes their dedication to their work.*

**4. *"But sweeter, O brothers, the kiss of the spray
And the dance of the wild foam's glee;
Row, brothers, row to the edge of the verge,
Where the low sky mates with the sea."***

Context: In these lines, the poet encourages the fishermen by showing that the sea offers even greater joys than the land. She highlights their deep connection with the ocean and motivates them to embrace its challenges.

Explanation: The poet contrasts the pleasures of the land with the excitement of the sea. She describes the "kiss of the spray" (the sea breeze) and the "dance of the wild foam" to show the beauty and energy of the ocean. The fishermen are called to row toward the horizon, where the "low sky mates with the sea," symbolizing endless opportunities and adventure. This line inspires them to embrace their destiny with enthusiasm.

**5. *"He who holds the storm by the hair,
Will hide in his breast our lives."***

Context: These lines express the fishermen's faith in divine protection. The poet reassures them that the same powerful force that controls the storm will also protect them as they venture into the sea.

Explanation: The poet refers to a higher power that controls the storm, implying that nature or God will safeguard the fishermen. The phrase "holds the storm by the hair" suggests great power, while "hide in his breast our lives" shows a sense of security and trust. This line highlights the fishermen's courage and their belief that they are under divine protection while facing the dangers of the sea.

III. 5 MARKS

1. How does Sarojini Naidu depict the life of fishermen in *The Coromandel Fishers*?

Sarojini Naidu's poem *The Coromandel Fishers* portrays the hardworking and adventurous spirit of fishermen. The poet uses vivid imagery and a lyrical tone to show their deep bond with nature.

The poem begins with an energetic call to the fishermen, urging them to wake up and embrace the new day. The sky is described as "wakening" and the wind as a "child that has cried all night." These metaphors create a peaceful yet determined mood. The sea is not just a workplace for the fishermen; it is their mother and protector, showing their spiritual and emotional connection to it.

Naidu also highlights the bravery of the fishermen, as they face the challenges of the sea without fear. She describes the sea waves and storms but emphasizes their confidence in the ocean's kindness. The poem ends on an encouraging note, calling the fishermen to sail beyond the land's boundaries and embrace the vast, limitless opportunities of the sea.

Through this poem, the poet celebrates the fishermen's courage, unity, and unwavering faith in nature. The rhythmic flow of words mirrors the movement of waves, making the poem lively and engaging.

2. Describe how the poem depicts the life of Coromandel Fishers.

The poem "*Coromandel Fishers*" by Sarojini Naidu offers a vivid and idealized portrayal of the lives of fishermen on the Coromandel Coast. The poem begins with a call to action as the speaker, one of the fishermen, urges his fellow comrades to wake up and prepare for a day of fishing. This opening reveals their disciplined routine and readiness to face the challenges of life at sea.

The poem reflects the fishermen's bravery and strong sense of unity. Despite the hardships and dangers of the sea, they are eager and enthusiastic. They do not fear the ocean but embrace it with

love and respect. The poet presents their life as adventurous, close to nature, and spiritually fulfilling. The sea is not just a place of work; it is their mother, their companion, and their home.

Naidu romanticizes their lifestyle, showing their bond with the natural world and their freedom from materialistic life. Even though the land offers the beauty of coconut groves and mango scents, the fishermen choose the call of the sea, the sound of the waves, and the thrill of fishing. This shows that their hearts lie not with comfort but with the deep, mysterious ocean, which defines their identity and way of life.

Through lyrical language, the poet conveys that the fishermen lead a life filled with purpose, courage, and spiritual richness. Their connection to the sea shapes not just their profession, but their entire existence.

2. Comment on the relationship between the fishermen and nature.

The relationship between the fishermen and nature in the poem "*Coromandel Fishers*" is portrayed as deeply spiritual, emotional, and harmonious. Nature is not just a background setting—it is a living, breathing part of the fishermen's lives. The sea, wind, clouds, and waves are all seen as companions and family members.

The speaker refers to the **sea as their mother**, which suggests a nurturing and protective bond. The **cloud is described as their brother**, and the **waves as their comrades**, showing that nature is viewed as equal, friendly, and dependable. This personification of nature shows a lifestyle where humans and the environment are not separate but deeply connected.

The fishermen rise with the dawn, following the natural rhythms of the day. They respect the power of the sea but are not afraid of it. Instead, they feel at home in its vastness. This close relationship

with nature also teaches them values such as courage, patience, and humility.

Unlike people who exploit nature for personal gain, the fishermen live in harmony with it. They take only what they need and rely on their experience and instincts to navigate the ocean. The poem thus reflects an eco-friendly, balanced life, where nature and human beings coexist with mutual respect and understanding.

This connection also adds a spiritual dimension to the poem. The fishermen offer prayers to the Sea God, acknowledging their dependence on nature's mercy. In today's world of environmental damage, this poem offers a powerful reminder of how deeply humans should respect and cherish the natural world.

3. Write a note on the figures of speech used in the poem.

Sarojini Naidu uses a variety of poetic devices and figures of speech in "*Coromandel Fishers*" to enhance the beauty, rhythm, and emotional depth of the poem. These literary techniques help convey both the external world of the fishermen and their inner feelings.

One of the most striking figures of speech is metaphor. The poet calls the sea their mother, the cloud their brother, and the **waves** their comrades. These metaphors show the deep emotional bond the fishermen share with nature. They do not see the sea as just water—it is a living presence, a source of love and livelihood.

Personification is another important figure of speech in the poem. The line "*The wind lies asleep in the arms of the dawn like a child that has cried all night*" gives human characteristics to the wind, portraying it as a child. This creates a soothing and calm image of the early morning, encouraging the fishermen to rise and begin their day.

The poet also uses **imagery** to bring the natural setting alive. Phrases like “*the shade of the coconut glade*”, “*the scent of the mango grove*”, and “*the kiss of the spray and the dance of the wild foam’s glee*” appeal to the senses and create vivid pictures in the reader’s mind.

Alliteration is present in lines such as “*sweet is the shade*” and “*kiss of the spray*”, where the repetition of consonant sounds adds a musical quality to the poem.

There is also symbolism in the contrast between land and sea. The shore symbolizes comfort and safety, while the sea represents adventure, freedom, and purpose. The fishermen’s choice to go to the sea shows their preference for a life of meaning over one of ease.

Overall, the use of figures of speech in “*Coromandel Fishers*” enriches the poem’s language and helps express the themes of courage, nature, and devotion to one’s calling.

2. WAR -LUGI PIRANDELLO

I. Short answer questions.

1. **Who are the main characters in the story?**

The main characters are the passengers in the second-class train carriage, particularly the fat, bald man and the fat woman who has just lost her son to war.

2. **Why were the passengers on the train travelling to Rome?**

The passengers were travelling to Rome to visit their sons who had been sent to fight in the war or to handle matters related to their sons' deaths or injuries.

3. **Why did the fat wife feel greatly grieved?**

She was deeply grieved because her only son had been sent to the war front just a day before, and she feared for his life.

4. **What was the last message of the fat old man's son?**

The old man said his son wrote in his last letter that he was happy to die for his country and did not want his parents to grieve for him.

5. **Who among the passengers in the carriage supports sending sons to the war front?**

The fat old man strongly supported the idea, saying that children belong more to the country than to their parents.

6. **Why does the fat old man burst into tears at the end of the story?**

He bursts into tears when the fat woman asks if his son is really dead, and he realizes the depth of his own suppressed grief.

II. LONG ANSWER

1. **What is the central theme of the story "War"? How is it illustrated?**

The central theme of "War" is the intense emotional conflict between parental love and patriotic duty during times of war. The story explores how ordinary people attempt to justify their suffering by embracing patriotic ideals, often masking their personal grief. It illustrates how war forces individuals to confront unbearable loss, compelling them to rationalize it for emotional survival.

This theme is illustrated through the interactions of the passengers in the train carriage. Each has been affected by the war—either their children are fighting or have died. The fat old man passionately defends the idea that their children belong more to their country than to their parents. He argues that dying for the country is honorable and that parents should not mourn such noble deaths. However, this rationalization is shattered when the fat woman—who has just sent her only son to the front—asks him quietly if his son is truly dead. This simple question pierces through his facade,

leading him to break down in tears, revealing the profound grief he had buried under patriotic reasoning. The theme is thus powerfully revealed through the emotional journey of the characters.

2. Comment on the conflict between parental love and patriotism as depicted in the story.

The story portrays a deep conflict between parental love and patriotism, showing how difficult it is for parents to balance love for their children with loyalty to their nation during wartime. The characters attempt to suppress their personal grief by clinging to patriotic ideals, suggesting that their children's sacrifices are noble and necessary.

The fat old man is the most vocal supporter of this belief. He insists that parents should feel proud rather than mournful when their children die for their country. Yet, his passionate speech is not entirely convincing; it feels like he is trying to convince himself as much as the others. The fat woman, who represents raw and honest parental love, cannot accept this emotional detachment. Her simple, heartfelt question—"Then... is your son really dead?"—exposes the emotional cracks in the old man's argument. It forces him to confront the truth: no amount of patriotism can replace the pain of losing a child. This conflict lies at the heart of the story and highlights the emotional cost of war for those left behind.

3. Discuss the symbols used and their significance in the story.

Pirandello uses **symbols** effectively to deepen the meaning of the story:

- **The train carriage** symbolizes a confined, transitional space where people from different walks of life come together, much like the war unites people through shared suffering. It's also a metaphor for the journey of grief and emotional realization.
- **The fat old man** symbolizes the societal voice of patriotic justification. His confident exterior hides the emotional turmoil within, showing how people cope with loss by clinging to ideals.
- **The fat woman** represents unfiltered grief and maternal love. Her quiet presence and sudden emotional question act as a catalyst for truth and honesty in the story.
- **The war itself** functions as an unseen but powerful symbol—it shapes the characters' lives, attitudes, and emotional states, though it is never directly depicted.

These symbols help Pirandello portray the emotional landscape of those left behind by war, showing how people rationalize or confront their suffering.

4. Write a note on the character of the fat old man.

The fat old man is one of the central characters in the story, and he represents a complex mix of pride, patriotism, denial, and hidden grief. Initially, he comes across as confident and self-assured. He speaks passionately about the nobility of dying for one's country and argues that parents should not mourn such deaths. His tone is almost boastful when he says that his son died happy and without regret.

However, this self-confidence is revealed to be a fragile mask. When the fat woman quietly questions him—"Is your son really dead?"—his facade crumbles. He is unable to answer and instead bursts into tears, overwhelmed by his own repressed sorrow. This emotional collapse reveals the depth of his love and pain, showing that his earlier speech was a way to cope with unbearable grief.

Through the fat old man, Pirandello masterfully portrays the duality of human emotion—how people hide personal agony behind public ideals, and how war leaves scars that no amount of patriotic pride can truly heal.

Summary

To his (oy Mistress)

NAME: _____
DATE: / /

Summary
-01

This poem written by Andrew Marvel
In the first stanza, the speaker details
what he would do if he and his beloved
had but ~~what~~^{world} had enough time, if they
had lifespan he explains about it would not
be a crime for her to be so coy.

His love could stretch far into the past 10
years before the flood and she could continue to
rejoice him till the conversation of the Jews.
In a world without a time he would be
able to spend an age at least admiring
every part of her. From her body to her heart
he admits that this is admiration & love that
she deserves and that he would grandly give
it to her if he could

In the second stanza, the speaker is
aware that time's winged chariot, it is
always in pursuit of a lover, each day that
his mistress meets his advance with her coyness
is a day closer to their death, after the death
the time on earth has elapsed they will
enter into deserts of vast eternity. In death
she will no longer be beautiful and he shall
no longer have the ability to praise her

In the final/third stanza the speaker
suggests solution to the problem of time
signified by the transition now therefore at
the beginning of the stanza the lover should
surrendering their love while they still exhibit
the speaker with violent imaginary to make this
argument

They can't stop time as represented by the sun but
they can make him run

Summary-02.

To his (oy mistress)

- Andrew Marvel

In the first stanza the poem begins with speaker imagining ideal, the world where time is unlimited, in such a world his mistress's royness/shyness would not be an issue. he describes how he would dedicated hundred or even thousand years playing her different part of body & soul. here the vegetable

Love symbolizes his slow, steady, natural love that would take his time to flourish much like a tree or plant growing over the centuries

In the second stanza he warns his mistress that they are growing older and one day she will loose her beauty & die. instead of being admired & loved she will be ~~lying in~~ ^{ending lying in} a cold ~~grave~~ ^{grave} where worms consume her body

this powerful image of time has a chariot convince the idea that the life is constantly moving forward & they cannot escape from death

In the third stanza, he describes that Love has something instantly comparing their passions to burning & fire rolling power, he also suggests that they should consume their youth & beauty together before it fades away. Finally he ends with powerful statements - since they can't stop time, they should use so passionately ~~then~~ that it feels like they are making time ~~more~~ ~~at~~ ~~fast~~ ^{faster}

In the last stanza poet tells ~~the~~ the lady that since they can't stop time, they should make the most most memorable. Time won't wait so let's enjoy life before we grow older. Now our love & energy are strong - let's use them before it's too late. If we can't stop time let's run fast and live happily _{with time.}

Summary

Ode to the west wind

- P.B Shelley

This poem written by P.B Shelley this poem is powerful, romantic poem where the poet describes the west wind as a force of both destruction and renewal he wishes for the wind to inspire and uplift him just as affect nature

In the first stanza:- the poet describes about the wind and the leaves, the west wind is describe as a destroyer and the preserver it sweeps away dead autumn leaves which are ^{compared} ~~compare~~ to ghost of plague ^{stricken} ~~stricken~~ ^{mystical} ~~free~~ ghosts this imaginary suggest and super natural power making the wind seen magical. (the colours yellow, black, pale and hectic red symbolises death, decay and disease) these leaves are called pestilence comparing them to a play (the wind like a chariot (vehicle) carrying dead leaves for their winter graves the wind also carries seeds which fall to the ground, ~~the~~ ~~at~~ and lie dormant during winter, the west wind has a sister wind in spring, spring will announce the new life, and the brings colour, fragrance and to bring / bringing new life.)

In the second stanza:- west wind moves through the sky, just like a moves through a forest, it carries clouds comparing to dead leaves floating through the forest these clouds are compare to decaying of the earth the wind brings ~~storm~~ storms, lightning and rain signifying both transformation & renewal.

20/11/19
wind & ocean
In the third stanza, the poet now shifts from describing nature to expressing his personal longings. He compares ~~in~~ himself to a dead leaf, a cloud, ~~away~~ wave of the weakness and powerfulness, this reflection ~~in~~ the waves gives the impression that these are treambled or dancing ~~in~~ the water.

wave
In the fourth stanza:- poet compares himself to the dead leaves, a cloud and a wave. He longs to be lifted and carried away by the wind, just like the natural elements. He also wishes to be like a wave in the ocean moving under the force of the west wind. He remembers his youth and boyhood which he felt free and powerful wind. ~~is~~

(In childhood he felt as if he was a friend to the west wind) moving freely if he still had that youthful energy and power he would not have to pray for winds helps now. The poet begs (request) the west wind to lift from like lifts waves, leaves and clouds)

In the fifth / last stanza :- he asks the west wind to use him as an instrument to spread his thoughts and ideas just as a scatters, leaves and seeds. He hopes his words will inspire and bring changes the poem ends with the famous hopeful line
"If winter comes, can Spring be far behind?"

Quality of Mercy.

The Quality of Mercy, this poem written by William Shakespeare, he is a famous speech from a merchant of Venice act I VC - 1 dialogue.

In the first stanza - Portia begins by using that mercy is not stained is not something that can be commanded Port says that Quality of mercy is never affected by anything it has come down Earth from the heaven like gentle rain from the sky she compares mercy to rain because if we recited Mercy is blessing for both the giver and taker mercy is divine quality a greater than kings power because it reflects god compassion she argues that justice alone is not enough if strict to justice ^{will} apply to everyone, no one would be same mercy tempers justice and brings through true salvation to the giver the mercy ~~was~~ ^{will} reward taker it is the life saver. It helps him from avoiding the punishment which he would have otherwise suffered

In the second stanza - True Justice alone ~~should~~ mean everyone. It punishes but mercy softens justice and makes it more humane since all people seek mercy to others Portia urge Shylock to be merciful reminding him that mercy is a divine and noble act. She appeals to Shylock to show mercy to Antonio hoping he would consider his demand for justice

This poem and the speech highlights the contrast between mercy and strict justice showing that True Justice must be tempered with kindness & forgiveness.

Quality of Mercy

This poem written by William Shakespeare In the first stanza - the poet says that the quality of mercy is never affected by anything it has come down on Earth from heaven like gentle rain. It is gentle as the rain drop and is send down on the Earth by god himself.

mercy is blessing for both the giver and the taker, to the giver the mercy ^{will} reward ^{his} taker, appreciation and love while to taker it is the life saver. (It helps him from punishment, avoiding the punishment which he would have otherwise suffered.) It helps them from punishment, ^{they would have suffered}

In the second stanza according to the poet mercy is the most powerful thing in the universe, it is something that makes a king better than his crown, in that his kingship he wades with his when moves with him to show his severity to show his power over his subject which makes the proper honour him and for from him.

In the third stanza - It continues from the last line of the previous stanza the might of the king might full fear in the hearts of the people, yet his quality of god himself, thus it a king is merciful he will be loved by the people and as god.

Coromandel Fishers

— Saroj

Summary:

This poem is written by Sarojini Naidu. The poem consists of three stanzas having 4 lines each. The poet describes the beauty of nature and the folk culture of the Coromandel coast of India. The poet describes the relationship of fishermen with the nature. Nature stands as a symbol of beauty that expresses the optimistic view of life.

The speaker in the poem is a fisherman who asks the fellow fisher folks to wake up and offer their prayers to the morning light. The wind is calm and quiet like a child that sleeps soundly after crying the whole night. He asks the fishermen to gather the ~~rest~~ nets and set their activities free and set out into the sea to gather the keeping wealth of the tide as they are the kings of the sea. He asks the fisher folks not to delay and quickly said in the trap of the sea gulls call.

He ~~comp~~ comforts his fellow fishermen by saying the sea is their mother, the cloud is their brother & the waves toss their boats at their edge and drive them far. God who controls the storm will protect them from its rage.

He also says that the coconut glade gives them shade and the sweet fragrance of the mango grove is soothing, moreover the ~~side of~~ sight of the sandy on full moon night is very beautiful mixed with voices of the birds early dawn. But beyond all this ~~is~~ the kiss,

of the , and the dawns of
is far sweeter. So he asked the fisher to
draw their boats to the edge of the boarder,
the horizon when the low sky appears to the
unique with the sea, but beyond all ~~thing~~
this thing the east of the spray's
dance of white folk far sweeter

Summary - 02

In the first stanza, the fishermen get up
as soon as they here dawns rise, the
sky longs for the light since it has been so
black for a such a long time the sky
welcomes the early light the wind blowing
all night longs say quite like a child, in
the motherly arms of their breathe. the fishermen
engage themselves in their routine. the sons of
the sea (the fishermen) get ready and capture
the fish that jumps into the sea

In Second stanza when they here dawns
cry, the fishers immediately go the sea
to capture fish they quickly leave in the
direction that the bird directs them they
look at the ocean as their mother the cloud
as their sibling and waves as their fellow
friends or soldiers they are constantly
tossed about while rising & falling sea
waves they are unconcern about their own
life they believe that the sea divine
would protect them from the ragging the
sea waves and conceal them in his breast
so they have no threat of growing

even as the sunsets

In the third stanza - the fishermen live in a calm environment; their homes and nature are flanked by mango & coconut trees they decade the plants loving fragrance there will always be share the full moons dazzling rays reflect of the ~~see~~ sand particles at the sea shore. creating the beautiful scenes that is well worth witnessing the fishermen believes this setting the water falls over the fishermen due to the huge sea waves. They like the wild sea waves dancing they are certain they will draw as far as the low sky needs the water at the horizon furthest limit.

The Unknown Citizen

Summary - 01
This poem written by W.H. Auden in year of 1939.

This poem describes of standardization at the expense of individualism. The poem begins with an epigraph which is a parody of those found on the tombs of the unknown soldiers. which appeared in many countries following the first world war. the name of the unknown citizen of the title only has JS/OT/M/378 et explain that this marble monument is erected by the state. According to the Bureau of Census JS/OT/M/378 was some body against whom a complaint had never been registered. He have been killed on his behaviour all of which longer that he was a soldier.

This assessment is justly because the unknown citizen serve the greater community in all his actions - throughout his life, apart from during the war when he was spend his entire life working in a factory without been dismissed.

On the contrary his employer found him satisfactory psychologically assessment of unknown citizen indicate that he was a popular man among his friends and enjoy drinking while the press notes that he purchased a daily paper and reacted in a completely normal way to all advertisements.

The unknown citizen was properly insured and all through he was one admitted to the hospital he recovered before leaving

to other govt departments produce research and high grade living observe that the citizen understood the benefits of the installment plan and possessed everything a modern citizen require to live his life. a phonograph, a radio, a car and a jigger brigade.

The poem then moves from the citizen behaviour to discuss his opinion. Researchers in this area agree that the citizen had the proper opinion for the time of year. the citizen was married men and he had a children which was at right number for a man of his age. the depiction of this poem finally seems some question but then immediately dismiss them. It suggest that asking whether the citizens had been free happy in his life.